A jobs week with a ten o'clock print three mornings running

Three consecutive mornings carry a top tier release at exactly 10:00 am eastern, and the week ends with the monthly jobs report. **Thursday is the only quiet morning on the calendar.**

CONTENTS

01 The week

What the market is already expecting. Surprises move price, not the number itself.

79K	4.2%	53.7	54.5	90K	64 to 67%
Jobs added, expected	Unemployment, expected	ISM factories, expected	ISM services, expected	ADP jobs, expected	September hike odds

Where the scheduled risk sits. Times are eastern.

MON 3	TUE 4	WED 5	THU 6	FRI 7
10:00	10:00	10:00	8:30	8:30
ISM factories, top tier	JOLTS job openings	ISM services, ADP 8:15	Claims, labour costs	Jobs report, Barkin 10:00
IN WINDOW	IN WINDOW	IN WINDOW	CLEAR	THE DAY

Red top marks a top tier release inside the 9:50 am to noon window.

02 Jobs

Four separate readings of the same question, spread across four days.

- **Tuesday 10:00 am,** (JOLTS (a count of unfilled job openings, one month behind))**.** Expected 7.3 million against 7.25 million.
- **Wednesday 8:15 am, ADP.** A private payroll estimate. Expected 90,000 against 75,000. It sets the lean into Friday.
- **Thursday 8:30 am, weekly claims plus unit labour costs.** Labour costs are expected to cool from 2.7 to 2.0 percent, which is the wage inflation read the rate debate hangs on.

- **Friday 8:30 am, the monthly jobs report.** Expected 79,000 jobs against 91,000, unemployment 4.2 percent against 4.3. **The whole day trades off this.**

03 The Fed

The committee held in July, but not quietly.

- Three officials dissented in favour of a rate hike, the most opposite direction dissents since 2016.
- September hike odds sit near 64 to 67 percent, down from effectively certain a week earlier. **This week's data is what moves that number.**
- Three officials speak: Cook Wednesday afternoon, Musalem Thursday evening, **and Barkin at 10:00 am Friday**, into the jobs reaction.
- The chair is Kevin Warsh, who runs shorter statements and less market communication than his predecessor. **Less guidance means bigger reactions.**

04 Earnings

More than a quarter of the S&P 500 reports in one week.

- Of roughly 300 companies reported so far, **85 percent have beaten expectations**, and earnings are tracking up about 27.7 percent from a year ago on an adjusted basis.
- Named on the calendar: Caterpillar, Palantir, Merck.
- The live argument is artificial intelligence spending. In three sessions the market punished it, forgave it, then rewarded it. Amazon posted record spending and rose 8.8 percent while Apple, which converted cash cleanly, fell 6.0 percent.
- One print is not a regime. Watch which way the third answer settles.

05 The catch

Two things are missing from this page on purpose.

- **The dealer positioning read is not available.** The weekly note that carries it was not published in time and the numbers behind it sit behind a paywall. **Blank beats guessed.**
- One reported item is unconfirmed: a week ahead preview named a large public market debut leading the calendar. It could not be verified from a second source and is flagged rather than stated.
- Volatility is cheap at 15.99 going into all of the above. That is the setup that makes a surprise land harder, not softer.

THE ONE LINE

Three top tier prints at 10:00 am, then the jobs report. The calendar is the risk this week, not the chart.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Release dates, times and consensus: tradingeconomics.com United States calendar, live lookup August 2 2026 (page renders UTC, converted at eastern equals UTC minus 4); Cross checked against IG Week Ahead August 3 2026, XTB, Kiplinger and CNBC, all four confirming ISM factories Monday 10:00, JOLTS Tuesday 10:00, ISM services Wednesday 10:00, jobs report Friday 8:30; Rate expectations: LSEG fed funds futures via Reuters; Earnings pace and beat rate: FactSet via CNBC.

Educational, not financial advice. A record of what happened and what is scheduled, for Mann's own discretion.

Glossary

ISM A monthly survey of purchasing managers. Above 50 means the sector is growing.

JOLTS A government count of unfilled job openings, reported one month behind.

ADP A private payroll company's estimate of jobs added, out two days before the official one.

Unit labour cost What it costs an employer in wages per unit of output. The cleanest wage inflation read.

Consensus What economists on average expect. Price moves on the gap to this, not on the number.

Dissent A Federal Reserve official voting against the decision.

Dealer positioning How options market makers are hedged. It shapes whether moves get damped or amplified.